

BUY YOUR HAPPINESS CONCLUSION

Most of us grew up being “warned” about money. More specifically, we were:

- » Warned not to overspend
- » Warned to take a safe job
- » Warned about the evil temptations of money
- » Warned about credit cards
- » Warned to save, save, save

You can see why it’s so easy for our parents, teachers, and so much of culture itself to caution us that money won’t buy happiness. There’s just one problem: It isn’t true!

Perhaps you heard about that old 2010 study by Daniel Kahneman and Angus Deaton stating that money makes us happy only up to an annual income of \$75,000 and then levels off. Well, research from a newer study shows that as your income grows, so does your happiness—and with no plateau.

That second study’s author, Wharton’s Matthew Killingsworth, pointed out why money drives happiness: “When you have more money, you have more choices about how to live your life. . . . Across decisions big and small, having more money gives a person more choices and a greater sense of autonomy.”

There are lots of scary implications for the usual gatekeepers who told you that money doesn’t make you happy—and even for ourselves! Are the rich happier than the poor? Is chasing money endlessly the only way for us to find happiness? What even *is* happiness, anyway? And, perhaps most hauntingly, is the real reason I’m not happy that I don’t have enough money?

Here’s what I’ve found: Money is an important part of a Rich Life, but just one piece of it. The blind accumulation of money will not make you